SURVIVAL-TIPS

Disaster Risk Reduction (DRR)

Risk awareness, emergency preparedness, first aid, shelter, evacuation, and immediate survival.

Stage 01 • Generated 2026-10-30 • 7 knowledge entries

How to use this handbook

Use this guide as a learning aid, not as a substitute for official emergency instructions or expert assessment. Every AI-extracted tip must be reviewed before it is treated as verified guidance. Never infer that a wild plant, mushroom, water source, or improvised material is safe based on appearance alone.

1. Use Local, Sustainable Materials

Plan emergency shelter solutions around locally available materials that can be sourced sustainably.

Action type: planning_guidance

Steps

1. Identify locally available materials and construction methods.
2. Assess whether sourcing can be sustained without damaging local resources.
3. Use suitable locally available materials in the shelter design.

Warnings

• The UNHCR entry is marked outdated and under revision; check current national and technical guidance before applying it.

Review status: needs_review • Category: other

Source: Emergency Shelter Solutions and Standards | UNHCR — https://emergency.unhcr.org/emergency-assistance/settlement-and-shelter/guidance-shelter/emergency-shelter-solutions-and-standards

2. Employ Plastic Sheeting as Primary Shelter Component

Plastic sheeting can be an important emergency-shelter component, often combined with rigid materials; it needs suitable support and has limitations in severe weather.

Action type: material_guidance

Steps

1. Consider plastic sheeting as one component of a shelter, potentially combined with rigid materials.
2. Provide an appropriate supporting frame or structure.
3. Assess local wind and rain exposure before relying on plastic sheeting as the main weather barrier.

Warnings

• Plastic sheeting alone does not provide strong resistance to high winds or heavy rain.

• Consider environmental impacts and responsible disposal.

Review status: needs_review • Category: other

Source: Emergency Shelter Solutions and Standards | UNHCR — https://emergency.unhcr.org/emergency-assistance/settlement-and-shelter/guidance-shelter/emergency-shelter-solutions-and-standards

3. Adhere to Minimum Covered Living Space Standards

UNHCR lists minimum covered living space of 3.5 m² per person in tropical or warm climates, and 4.5–5.5 m² indoor living space per person in cold climates.

Action type: shelter_standard

Steps

1. For tropical or warm climates, use 3.5 m² per person as the cited minimum covered living-space figure.
2. For cold climates, use 4.5–5.5 m² per person as the cited indoor living-space range.
3. Check the full standard for scope, exclusions, and local requirements before applying the figures.

Warnings

• These figures have different climate contexts and are not interchangeable; the UNHCR entry is marked outdated and under revision.

Review status: needs_review • Category: other

Source: Emergency Shelter Solutions and Standards | UNHCR — https://emergency.unhcr.org/emergency-assistance/settlement-and-shelter/guidance-shelter/emergency-shelter-solutions-and-standards

4. Maintain Minimum Shelter Height for Ventilation

For warm-climate shelter guidance, UNHCR specifies a minimum height of 2 m at the lowest point, with greater height preferable for air circulation and ventilation.

Action type: shelter_standard

Steps

1. Check the shelter height at its lowest point.

2. For the cited warm-climate guidance, provide at least 2 m at the lowest point where feasible.

3. Consider greater height to support air circulation and ventilation.

Warnings

• The cited 2 m figure is context-specific; do not treat it as a universal standard. The UNHCR entry is marked outdated and under revision.

Review status: needs_review • Category: other

Source: Emergency Shelter Solutions and Standards | UNHCR — https://emergency.unhcr.org/emergency-assistance/settlement-and-shelter/guidance-shelter/emergency-shelter-solutions-and-standards

5. Insulate and Seal Shelters in Cold Climates

In cold climates, UNHCR recommends covering windows and doors with translucent plastic sheeting and designing walls, ceilings, and floors to insulate against cold air.

Action type: cold_climate_shelter_guidance

Steps

1. Cover windows and doors with translucent plastic sheeting as described in the source.

2. Design walls, ceilings, and floors to provide insulation from cold air.

Warnings

• The cited entry is marked outdated and under revision. Consider ventilation and safe heating when improving insulation.

Review status: needs_review • Category: other

Source: Emergency Shelter Solutions and Standards | UNHCR — https://emergency.unhcr.org/emergency-assistance/settlement-and-shelter/guidance-shelter/emergency-shelter-solutions-and-standards

6. Use Adequate Heating Stoves in Cold Environments

UNHCR gives 5–7 kW as an indicative stove output for heating 40–70 m² in many cold areas, depending on conditions; it is not a universal sizing rule.

Action type: heating_reference

Steps

1. Treat 5–7 kW for 40–70 m² only as an indicative reference from the cited UNHCR guidance.

2. Assess outside temperature, building construction, insulation, orientation, and actual stove performance before selecting heating equipment.

3. Follow appropriate installation, ventilation, and fire-safety requirements.

Warnings

• Heating needs vary with conditions; the UNHCR entry is marked outdated and under revision. Poorly installed fuel-burning stoves can cause fire and carbon-monoxide hazards.

Review status: needs_review • Category: energy

Source: Emergency Shelter Solutions and Standards | UNHCR — https://emergency.unhcr.org/emergency-assistance/settlement-and-shelter/guidance-shelter/emergency-shelter-solutions-and-standards

7. Avoid Crossing Flooded Roads or Walkways

If you approach a flooded road or walkway, turn around rather than attempting to cross it.

Action type: safety_rule

Prerequisites

• Presence of a flooded road or walkway

Steps

1. If you approach a flooded road or walkway, turn around and do not cross.

Expected result: Avoid drowning and potential injury.

Failure modes / limitations

• Ignoring the rule and crossing the flooded area.

Warnings

• Floodwater can conceal hazards and may be deeper or faster-moving than it appears.

Review status: needs_review • Category: first_aid

Source: Floods | Ready.gov — https://www.ready.gov/floods